

The Cyborg Times

January 1, 2020 * 4 Pages * Cyborg Stories of Yore

Defying Death

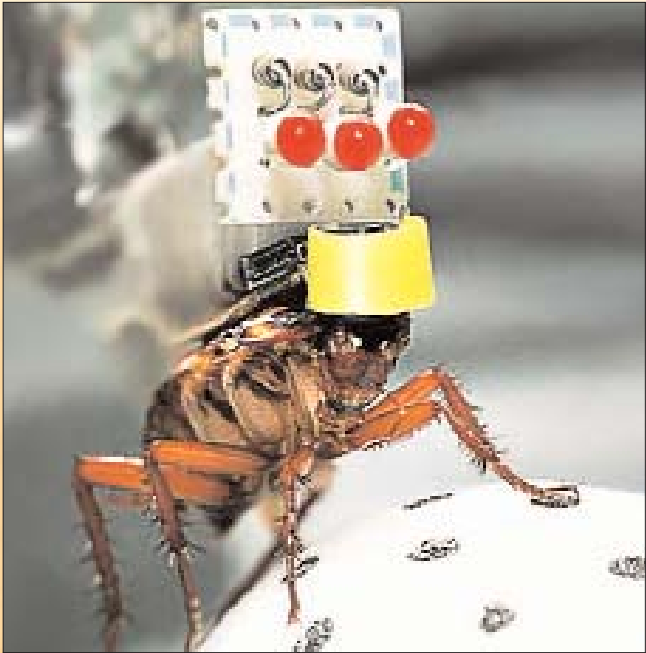
Mumbai: Which of the following is science fiction?
(a) A rat's brain flying a plane
(b) An android removing his biological eye
(c) A monkey controlling a robot using its thoughts

Though it is the least weird of the three, the answer is (b)—from the movie *Terminator*. Yes, it's finally come to pass—science fact is truly stranger than science fiction. We have all watched blockbusters such as *Terminator*, and are all familiar with the terms cyborg, cybernetics, android, etc. However, what is a cyborg? Dictionary.com's definition: "Cyborg: A

human who has certain physiological processes aided or controlled by mechanical or electronic devices." So, in theory, a person with an artificial limb, or heart, or lung, or even a hearing aid, could be considered a cyborg.

However, this is not about nit-picking over definitions, it's about us, humans, and how technology is changing us; making us evolve into part-tech, part-tissue beings.

So how many people that you know are already on their way to becoming a cyborg? There are several out there already!



A cyborg cockroach. The cockroach has, attached to its head, electrodes that can be remote controlled

Life As A Cyborg!

It's 2050: are you still completely human? Read on to find out what you are missing in life...

Experience A Much Richer World: Wire up your brain to accept all kinds of input, beyond your current five senses. See the "colours" of an X-Ray, "smell" an infrared signal!

Control Yourself Via A Computer: Using brain implants, you can unite with a computer that stores all your experiences. You can then play them back when you wish, truly reliving each moment!

Have Infinite Knowledge: A global consortium of supercomputers awaits! Everyone's experiences and knowledge are stored inside this collective. Log in to absorb global knowledge on the subject of your choice.

Relive other's experiences!

Mini-Me: Instead of a companion computer that resembles a metallic box, why not employ a clone instead!? With a computer instead of a brain in his skull—send him out on a mission, and experience the dangers of life through him.

Never Die: When a body part malfunctions or drops below a specific performance level, your trusty Mini-Me will remind you that you need to have a servicing done. Even if your brain starts dying, create a clone, upload all your brain data to the new brain, and live on through the new brain and body.

"I Want To Be A Cyborg"

"My being born a human, an accident," Kevin Warwick confesses

Reading, UK: Kevin Warwick, Professor in the Department of Cybernetics at the University of Reading, has proclaimed that his being born human was "an accident of fate," which he says, can be changed. In his "Project Cyborg," Warwick experimented with what measure of control could be achieved using implants—electronic chips married to his body, specifically, his arm.

His first implant, in 1998, allowed him to control doors and such by hand gestures or by walking in a certain direction; in 2002, an implant consisting of an array of 100 electrodes, with a neural interface allowed him to go

beyond that.

The new implant sends signals back and forth between Warwick's nervous system and a computer. The idea is to "tap into his nerve fibres" and try a series of experiments. His first goal was to record and identify signals associated with motion.

When he twiddled his left index finger, a signal was sent, via the implant, to a computer where it was then recorded and stored. The next step was to transmit this signal back to the implant, in an attempt to generate an action in Warwick—trying to get his left index finger to twiddle.

Contd on next page...